GC_COMBO_v2 · 10:00 BLEND + STRETCH SHORT · @GC FUTURES

Hypothesis:

Tested rule: at 10:00 ET, add five fixed-sign votes (morning price, against morning taker flow, GLD creations, big crude move, price again on dollar-decoupled days). Sum ≥ +2 buy, ≤ −2 sell, next bar; exit the 13:30 settlement bar, no stop. Separately, short when price closes 0.5 ATR under session VWAP; stop 0.505 ATR, target 2R. One position at a time. It passed a sealed out-of-sample read. The mechanism is still an open case.

Why it should exist: no single gold flow pays the round turn on its own. Each vote is a small, sourced edge — the New York morning move continues, aggressive morning takers get faded, GLD authorised participants must buy or sell bullion after creations and redemptions, a large crude shock moves inflation hedges, and on days gold ignores the dollar its own flow dominates. Stacked, the cost is paid once. The stretch short is different: a downside break of VWAP in gold is liquidation, a cascade, not an overreaction.

What this note proves: the frozen rule survived a sealed 2025–26 read on three pre-declared marks, and MultiCharts reconciles trade-for-trade with an independent Python replay. What it does not prove: that each story behind each vote is the true cause, or why 10:00 New York and not the London auction. Treat the votes as the hypothesis and the frozen rule as the result.

PROVED

Sealed OOS 2025-01 → 2026-08: 230 trades, +$289/trade, 2.77/wk. All three pre-declared marks passed on one read.

PROVED

No single vote carries it: drop any one of five and the blend still holds (t 3.1–4.5). Every IS year positive. MC reconciles to Python on 884/884 same-minute directions.

OPEN CASE

230 OOS trades alone are thin (t 0.9 in bp). 10:00 is a peak, not a plateau. The stretch short lost in 2025's +65% gold year.

Who loses

Morning takers

Chased the tape 08:21–10:00 with aggressive orders. Following their net flow to 13:30 wins 45.6% of 2,088 days, −3.1 bp, t −3.2.

Who is forced

ETF APs & liquidating longs

GLD creations are hedged in bullion (vote alone +2.6 bp, t 1.9). Longs liquidate through VWAP (stretch IS +9.4 bp, 314 trades). Neither can wait.

Who wins

The patient holder

Holds the agreed direction 10:01 → 13:30. Blend 2016–24: 715 days, 58.7% WR, +7.9 bp, t 4.6. One round turn for five edges.

THREE REAL DAYS · @GC 1-MINUTE ET · EACH THE MEDIAN DAY OF ITS TYPE, 2016–24 · DOTTED = SESSION VWAP



BLEND · THE CELL

2019-07-24: score 3+, short 2 lots at 10:01, out 13:30, +4.0 pt a contract. The drift is spread across the path; stops cut it.

STRETCH · THE CASCADE

2021-11-30: close 0.5 ATR under VWAP, short 11:02, stop 12.7 pt, target 25.4 pt; flat 16:00 at +5.9 pt.

SPLIT VOTES · NO TRADE

2020-12-23: votes +1 −1 −1 0 +1, score 0, flat. Quiet regimes live here: ~$0/day in the quietest 40%.

IN-SAMPLE vs OUT-OF-SAMPLE · MULTICHARTS @GC · SPLIT 2025-01-01 · INIT $50,000



Method:

GC futures on 1-minute full-session bars. Blend: at 10:00 ET sum five fixed-sign votes; |score| ≥ 2 trades next bar, exit on the 13:30 ET bar close, no stop. Stretch: short a close 0.5 ATR below session VWAP (anchor 18:01 ET) between 08:20 and 15:00; stop 0.505 ATR, target 2R, flat 16:00. One position at a time, first signal wins. Frozen once. Not optimised on the vault.

INSTRUMENT
GC futures. Research size 1 GC, 2 at |score| ≥ 3. Prop ticket @MGC, same contract counts.

BARS
1-minute, full Globex session, trade volume with up/down split. Next-bar only. IOG off.

LIVE CLOCK
Logic in ET. Chart on Central, ETminusChart = 1. Decision 10:00 ET = 09:00 CT. Exit 13:30 ET.

EXTRA DATA
Data2 @CL 1-min (17:00 ET crude move). Data3 GCCOMBO daily file: GLD vote + dollar-decoupled flag.

IN-SAMPLE
Research 2016-10 → 2024-12. This export 2017-09-18 → 2024-12-31: 974 trades.

OUT-OF-SAMPLE
Sealed until read. 2025-01-01 → 2026-08-07: 230 trades. Read once, against pre-declared marks.

COST
$2.30/side GC commission + 1 tick slippage per side. Research used $19.20–$29 RT.

FROZEN RULE
k = 2, 10:00 decision, 13:30 exit, stretch 0.5 / 0.505 / 2R. Named once. Hold-out spent → no more tuning.

SIZE OVERLAY
Conviction only: 1 lot at |score| = 2, 2 lots at ≥ 3. The one lever that survived the maximise round.

MULTIPLICITY
Every test logged. GC programme ledger N = 10,831. Deflated Sharpe fails at that N; the sealed read is the counter-evidence.

NAMED KILLS
Stops/targets, ADX, RVOL, NQ-style brackets, 27-cell averaging, release-day skip, stacking, conviction-only.

NOT THIS
Not a London-fix trade. Not a round-number stop run. Not minute-scale mean reversion (8–40× too small on gold).

Why 10:00

27 neighbouring cells, 2016–24, every one profitable. Decision 10:00 = $49–112k, 09:45 = $28–77k, 10:15 = $19–73k. 10:00 is the peak. Exit 13:30 ≈ 14:00 > 13:00; stretch 0.5 ≈ 0.6 > 0.4. Averaging the 27 kept only 58% of the profit, so the frozen cell stays.

Not the London auction

10:00 ET = 15:00 London = the LBMA PM auction. In US/UK DST-mismatch weeks the auction moves to 11:00 ET. The edge stayed at 10:00 (18.1 vs 12.5 bp per trade, n ≈ 50). This is a New York morning drift.

Stops tax the drift

30 exit cells: RoMaD flat at 8.6–11.2 vs baseline 10.98. Tight 0.35U stops cost edge monotonically. NQ-style brackets (RR 0.5–1): 0 of 9 beat the time exit. Drawdown is handled by size, not exits.

Conviction

MC per contract: score 2 $32 IS → $248 OOS; score ≥ 3 $176 → $261. The gap shrank out of sample. Both kept; dropping score 2 passed in-sample and was not adopted.

Prop fit

Lucid Flex 50K at 1 MGC (2 on conviction), 2016–24 bootstrap: 90% pass, 4.9% bust, median 181 trading days. Slow, not fragile. With NQ DriftBreak v2 at 2 MNQ in the same account: 89% pass in 99 days (daily corr −0.02).

A volatility harvester

By causal regime (prior 20-session range): ~$0/day in the quietest two fifths, $80–118/day otherwise. 2018–19 went flat for a year. In basis points 2025 was the weak year (1.6 bp), 2026 above average (10.4 bp); z −0.6 vs IS: noise, not decay.

Results:

WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	PROFIT FACTOR	NET PROFIT
52.5%	$187.64	1.37	$225,916

TRADES	MAX DD	IS AVG	OOS AVG
1,204	−$43,747	$163.71	$288.98

EVERY YEAR · MULTICHARTS @GC · GROSS BASIS POINTS PER TRADE (SCALE-FREE) AND NET $

Year	2017*	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026*
Trades	29	122	136	123	133	156	119	156	157	73
WR	69%	51%	51%	54%	51%	58%	50%	56%	47%	45%
bp / trade	17.5	3.5	5.9	15.7	4.1	6.3	5.9	8.8	1.6	10.4
Net $	7.6k	4.7k	9.3k	48.1k	12.6k	30.6k	13.3k	33.2k	23.0k	43.4k
Gold avg	1,278	1,271	1,397	1,746	1,795	1,809	1,954	2,443	3,450	4,638

* part years (2017 from 09-18; 2026 to 08-07). Amber = sealed out-of-sample. Dollars scale with the gold price; basis points do not. OOS mean 4.4 bp vs IS 7.5 bp (z −0.6): inside noise, 2025 thin, 2026 above average.

THE VOTES · RESEARCH PANEL 2016-10 → 2024-12 · GROSS, 10:01 OPEN → 13:30 CLOSE, 1 GC

Vote	alone: days	WR	bp	t	blend WITHOUT it: n	WR	bp	t
A Price 08:20→10:00	2,072	51.6%	1.3	1.36	625	56.2%	6.3	3.53
B Against taker flow	2,088	53.5%	3.1	3.20	769	54.6%	5.4	3.12
C GLD creations	1,212	51.1%	2.6	1.93	692	58.8%	7.2	4.10
D Big crude move	482	52.7%	3.8	1.80	665	58.8%	7.0	4.02
E Price, $-decoupled	446	56.1%	6.4	2.49	599	59.8%	8.4	4.51
ALL FIVE, |score| ≥ 2	–				715	58.7%	7.9	4.62
score = 2 / score ≥ 3	–				421 / 294	55.1 / 63.9%	5.3 / 11.8	2.41 / 4.26
FOLLOW the taker flow	2,088	45.6%	-3.1	-3.20				

B is the strongest alone (t 3.2); A, C and D are weak alone and matter in the stack. Dropping A or B costs the most. Dropping E raises bp per trade but cuts 116 trades: E buys frequency, not edge.

MULTICHARTS · $2.30/SIDE + 1 TICK · 1–2 GC · SINGLE SOURCE, 2017-09-18 → 2026-08-07

Cell	n	/wk	WR	bp	$ / trade	avg win / loss
IS < 2025 blend	660	1.74	55.2%	6.6	$166.74	
IS < 2025 stretch	314	0.84	51.3%	9.4	$157.34	
IS total	974	2.56	53.9%	7.5	$163.71	$932 / −$734 (1.27)
OOS blend	163	1.96	51.5%	6.8	$386.03	
OOS stretch	67	0.83	34.3%	-1.4	$52.86	
OOS total	230	2.77	46.5%	4.4	$288.98	$3,238 / −$2,276 (1.42)

OOS win rate fell (46.5%) but the win/loss ratio rose (1.42): a fat-tailed payoff, not a broken one. The blend held its bp exactly (6.6 → 6.8); the weakness is the short-only stretch in a record bull year. Run with limit fills "1 tick beyond" (vs Classic it changes one trade, −$150).

Conclusion:

The frozen COMBO is the result. IS 974 trades, 53.9% WR, +$164. OOS 230 trades, 46.5% WR, +$289. All three pre-declared marks passed on one read. No single vote carries it, following the morning takers loses, and alternative exits, filters and clocks fail. That is the proof.

One version. No vault optimisation. The hold-out is now spent, so the rule is frozen. That reduces, but does not eliminate, regime risk. It is a volatility harvester with a fat-tailed payoff (~50% WR, win/loss 1.4). 230 OOS trades are thin on their own (t 0.9 in bp). Do not send this as proof of any single flow; the forward record decides.

NAMED KILLS · SAME DATA, THESE DO NOT GET TO CHANGE THE RULE

Stops & targets

30 exit cells, RoMaD 8.6–11.2 vs 10.98 baseline. Tight stops cut the drift monotonically.

NQ-style brackets

RR 0.5–1, 9 cells: WR up to 61.7% but net falls to 0.89× RT. Best only ties the time exit.

ADX / RVOL

ADX ≥ 20 $118 vs random-filter p95 $137. RVOL ≥ 1 $86 vs $155. Both dropped.

27-cell averaging

All 27 profitable, but the average keeps 58% of the profit and lowers RoMaD in both halves.

Release-day skip

ISM days −0.3 bp vs 8.8 (t −1.48). Declared check on Conference Board days: +13.8 bp. Noise.

Conviction-only

|score| ≥ 3 passes in-sample (Flex 95% vs 90%) but OOS score-2 trades earned $248/ct. Not adopted.

What I will not do: add a stop, move the 10:00 clock, drop score-2 trades, stack same-side signals, or change anything after watching 2025–26.

What I want feedback on:

1. Per-vote forward table. In-sample no vote carries it and E adds frequency, not edge. Log each vote on data after 2026-09-25: if one vote starts carrying it, the blend story is wrong.
2. Run the same frozen rule on silver (SI), unchanged. Same macro flows, a different ETF (SLV). If SI lives, this is a precious-metals flow story; if it is dead, it is gold-specific.
3. If you have bid/ask data: rebuild vote B from true order-flow imbalance instead of the tick rule. Report forward results only; anything tuned on 2016–26 is snooping.

Attached:

GC_COMBO_v2_community.txt (every vote, sleeve, time and filter is an input; defaults = the tested rule) · GCCOMBO.txt (the data3 file) · setup steps on page 5 · markdown table:

Cell	Source	n	WR	bp	$/trade
Blend, all five votes, abs score >= 2	research 2016-24	715	58.7%	7.9 (t 4.62)	-
Follow the morning taker flow	research 2016-24	2088	45.6%	-3.1 (t -3.20)	-
Blend without vote A/B/C/D/E	research 2016-24	625-769	54.6-59.8%	5.4-8.4 (t 3.1-4.5)	-
MC IS < 2025-01-01	MultiCharts	974	53.9%	7.5	$163.71
MC OOS >= 2025-01-01	MultiCharts	230	46.5%	4.4	$288.98
MC all 2017-09 -> 2026-08	MultiCharts	1204	52.5%	-	$187.64

Setup:

Two files: `GC_COMBO_v2_community.txt` (the strategy) and `GCCOMBO.txt` (one bar a day: the GLD vote and the dollar-decoupled flag). About 15 minutes in MultiCharts. Do the steps in order.

STEP 1 · THE STRATEGY

Open the **PowerLanguage Editor** → File → New → **Signal**. Name it `GC_COMBO_v2_community`. Delete the template text, paste the whole .txt file in, press **F3** to compile. It must say "compiled successfully".

STEP 2 · THE DATA FILE

Put `GCCOMBO.txt` in a folder **on its own** (e.g. `C:\MCData\GCCOMBO\`). Keep the name exactly `GCCOMBO.txt`: the file name becomes the symbol name.

STEP 3 · MAP IT IN QUOTEMANAGER

QuoteManager → File → **Map ASCII...** → Browse to that folder. Click the blue **GCCOMBO** file link and check: fields Date, Time, Open, High, Low, Close, Volume · Start at Row **2** · Resolution **1 Minute** (type the 1 in the small box) · Time Zone **Exchange**. OK, then OK. It should say "mapped 1 file successfully".

STEP 4 · THE CHART (ORDER MATTERS)

Data 1: @GC, 1 Minute, full Globex session, Build Volume on **Trade Volume**.
Data 2: @CL, 1 Minute.
Data 3: Insert Instrument → data source **ASCII Mapping** → GCCOMBO, 1 Minute. Then Format Instrument → Settings → Sessions = **24/5**.
Data range for all three: from 2017 (the ATR and crude votes need ~20 sessions to warm up).

STEP 5 · INSERT + SETTINGS

Insert → Strategy → `GC_COMBO_v2_community`. Leave every input at default except **ETminusChart** = hours to ADD to your chart clock to get New York time: exchange/Central chart = **1**, New York chart = **0**, London chart = **−5**. Strategy Properties: commission (tested at $2.30/side GC), slippage **1 tick**, Backtesting → fill limit orders when price goes **beyond by 1 tick** (not Classic).

STEP 6 · CHECK IT MATCHES

Backtest 2017-09-18 → 2026-08-07 on @GC: about **1,204 trades, ~$226k net, 52.5% WR**. Small differences are your data vendor (tested on Rithmic GC). A big difference means a step above is off.

IF THE GCCOMBO PANE SAYS "NO DATA"

1. Chart resolution must be **1 Minute**, not 1 Day.
2. Session must be **24/5** (the bar is stamped 05:00; a 09:30–16:00 session hides it).
3. In Map ASCII the resolution must read **1 Minute**. If it says 1 Day, click the file link and fix it.
4. Click the chart, press **Ctrl+R** to reload.

KEEPING IT UPDATED

GCCOMBO.txt ends on the date I posted it. I will post updated files: overwrite the old one in the same folder and press Ctrl+R. No crude or GCCOMBO feed? Put any symbol in that slot and switch the votes it feeds off (UseVoteOil for data 2; UseVoteGLD + UseVoteDecouple for data 3). The strategy still needs three data series on the chart.

File → Save Workspace when it works. MultiCharts does not keep an unsaved chart through a crash.